

AGE OLD PC MYTHS THAT REFUSE TO DIE

We've all believed them some time or the other.
It's high time we put these myths to rest.

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Personal Computers have been around for a really long time. And with all things that have lasted this long, weird stories tend to arise.

Some have a fairly logical rationale explaining these stories and some have simply been relegated to the domain of myths as hardware evolves to overcome these “drawbacks”. We’re taking a look at some of these concepts which did hold water a couple of years back but have simply become illogical over time.

SLOW BECAUSE OF AN INFECTION

Got a slow machine? Talk to your techy friend? He or she, most probably, put the blame on a PC infection. At least, that’s what used to be the most common reason. However, these days, your PC slowing down could be because of a myriad of reasons. Perhaps, you’ve installed way too many software which now have many persistent services running in the background. Or perhaps, your habits have changed and you’ve become a more extravagant user. This writer is known to exploit as much RAM as he gets and

that’s evidenced by the 100s of tabs persistent on his machine.

Your PC could have become slow for a multitude of reasons and you need to diagnose the proper reason and remedy that accordingly. Perhaps, you simply need more RAM to accommodate your improved multi-tasking abilities. Or perhaps, the latest build of a software has a memory leak issue. If all else fails, then perhaps you do have a bitcoin miner running at a persistent load on your machine or worse, an infection.

POWER DOWN YOUR PCs

Everything has a limited life. When it comes to electronics, we use the term Mean Time Between Failure to describe the same. The MTBF for most hardware these days is approximately 1-2 million hours which means it’ll be about 114-228 years before normal operation can lead to a failure. However, we all know about planned obsolescence practised in the industry. This means the real life of your hardware can be as low as five years if you’re unlucky or as high as 40 years

(certain hard drives have lasted this long) if lady luck is on your side.

And if the “powering your PC down” argument was presented from the power saving angle, then you should be aware of the different power states that most hardware come with. CPUs have C-states and P-states, the former can help save power when the PC goes into sleep and the latter helps when the PC is down but not under load. With hard drives, most brands now have a variable RPM that slows down your spindle spin speed if you aren’t accessing much data. Even graphics cards which are power hogs will run at approximately 1/10th of their full load when idle, resulting in significant power savings. Running your computer persistently is no longer the technological taboo that it used to be.

NO NEED FOR AN ANTI-VIRUS

If you were smart enough while operating your computer, then you simply didn’t need an anti-virus software. Making use of a linux-live disk for accessing doubtful USB drives, using a sandbox